



Mega CO2 Sucking Plants – the next big tool against Global Warming

Commercially viable plants that can extract CO₂ from the air just hit a huge milestone with one such facility opening up in Zurich, Switzerland.

Climeworks is a company with an ambitious goal: Reducing global emissions by one whole percent. Now that might not seem as much, but considering the amount of CO₂ released in 2015 alone was close to 10 BILLION tonnes, one percent is a worthy accomplishment. Scientists have known several methods to suck up atmospheric CO₂ over the years but all of these were experimental or prohibitively expensive until now.

Climeworks' plant, works on the principle of special chemical sponges. The coating on the surface of these sponges interacts with the CO₂ molecules in the air to heat them to about 100°C and separate them and store them inside. Once a sponge has been saturated, the stored CO₂ can be extracted and used for several purposes, such as fizzing up beverages, further decomposition to get pure carbon to make other products or even pumping it into greenhouses to increase fruit and vegetable yield. They call this technology as Direct Air Capture or DAC.

<http://dgit.in/SuckCO2>

Storing rare seeds before extinction

Hawaii has an island ecosystem where the plant species there have evolved for millions of years in total isolation. These plants lived cut off from the rest of the world all the time and so they are highly vulnerable. But recently it has been estimated that the island has lost over 130 different plant species due to climate change and interruption by humans and other invasive animals.



The National Tropical Botanical Garden on the Hawaiian island of Kaua'i is a seed bank with 80,000 dried plant specimens and over 3 millions seeds of Hawaii's rarest plants in store that is trying to preserve these delicate live forms from total extinction so they can be replanted again when it is time. Some of the seeds have actually sprouted and grown into plants, so researchers can study better ways of preserving and also collect new seeds from the plants.

<http://dgit.in/RIPseed>

Physics behind Wonder Woman's bracelets



Anyone who knows Wonder Woman clearly knows about her Bracelets

of Submission. Those indestructible metal (of some sorts) bracelets that can absorb the impact of bullets or any incoming projectiles. But what does physics have to say about it?

<http://dgit.in/WWbrace>

Beyond the five senses



Science and technology has long been used to help people who have lost, or were born without, one of the five primary senses. But have we actually reached the state of achieving additional sensory enhancements using science?

<http://dgit.in/Sense6>

The Lone Star Tick is spreading



One bite from the *Amblyomma americanum*, also known as

the Lone Star Tick is enough to reprogram your immune system to forever reject any red meat with allergies for the rest of your lives. In the last year, more than 100 new cases have been registered.

<http://dgit.in/StarTick>